

Accessibility for Customer Service Policy

Policy Summary & Knowledge Check

Authority	Board of Directors
Date Ratified	December 6, 2024
Next Review Date	December 2027
Previous Amendments	November 15, 2011

Policy Summary

This policy ensures the USC respects all customers, regardless of their abilities, in compliance with the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act (AODA), 2005, and its Customer Service Standard. It applies to all USC employees, volunteers, and visitors, and covers assistive devices, service animals, support persons, temporary service disruptions, staff training, and the feedback process.

Key Takeaways

- Applies to all USC employees, volunteers, and visitors, and addresses accessibility of services, products, and spaces for people with disabilities.
- The USC welcomes the use of assistive devices, and welcomes service animals onto premises open to the public, committing to find alternatives where an animal is legally prohibited, such as for health or safety reasons.
- A person with a disability accompanied by a support person will be allowed to have that person accompany them on USC premises; where a fee applies to the support person's admission, it will be communicated and posted accordingly.
- The USC will notify customers promptly of planned or unexpected disruptions to services or facilities for customers with disabilities, including the reason, anticipated length, and alternatives, if available.
- Training is provided to employees, volunteers, and anyone developing USC policies, practices, or procedures affecting the public, covering interacting with people with disabilities, using assistive devices/equipment, and what to do if a person with a disability is having difficulty accessing goods or services; training records, including dates and numbers trained, are kept.
- The USC welcomes feedback, in person, by telephone, in writing, or electronically, on how it provides accessible goods and services, and will make every reasonable and timely effort to respond to complaints and answer questions; related documents are available in accessible formats upon request.

Knowledge Check

5 situational questions to check understanding of this policy. An answer key follows on the next page.

Q1. A customer with a disability wants to bring their service animal into a USC public-facing space. What is the USC's approach?

- A. Service animals are never permitted indoors.
- B. The USC welcomes service animals onto premises open to the public, and commits to finding alternatives where animals are legally prohibited.
- C. Only guide dogs are permitted; no other service animals.
- D. A written doctor's note is required at every visit.

Q2. The USC needs to temporarily close an accessible entrance for repairs. What must it do?

- A. Wait until the repair is finished before announcing anything.
- B. Nothing, as long as repairs are completed quickly.

- C. Notify customers promptly with a clearly posted notice including the reason, anticipated length, and available alternatives.
- D. Only inform USC staff, not the public.

Q3. A support person accompanies a customer with a disability into a paid event. If a fee applies to the support person, what must the USC do?

- A. Charge the support person double the standard fee.
- B. It is never permitted to charge a fee for a support person.
- C. Always waive the fee automatically.
- D. Communicate and post the fee accordingly through the USC's website, brochure, or other public methods.

Q4. When must training on this policy be provided to a new employee who deals with the public?

- A. As soon as practicable after being assigned applicable duties.
- B. Within their first year, at any point.
- C. Only during annual refresher sessions.
- D. Only if the employee requests it.

Q5. A customer wants to provide feedback about their accessibility experience with the USC. How can this be submitted?

- A. Only by mail.
- B. In person, by telephone, in writing, or electronically via email or other digital formats.
- C. Only through a third-party ombudsperson.
- D. Feedback is not accepted from the general public.

Answer Key

Q1: B — Section 4.2.1 states the USC welcomes persons with disabilities accompanied by a service animal onto premises open to the public, and commits to finding alternatives if service animals are prohibited by law.

Q2: C — Section 4.4.1 requires prompt notification of service disruptions via a clearly posted notice including the reason, anticipated length, and alternatives, if available.

Q3: D — Section 4.3.2 states that where a fee applies to a support person's admission, it will be communicated and posted through the USC's website, brochure, or other public methods.

Q4: A — Section 4.5.3 states training will be provided to each person as soon as practicable after being assigned applicable duties.

Q5: B — Section 4.6.1 states feedback can be given in person, by telephone, in writing, or electronically via email or other digital formats.